5. Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia (ESCWA)

The *Standing Committees* of the Council are the:

1. Committee for Programme and Coordination
2. Committee on Non-Governmental Organizations
3. Committee on Negotiations with Inter-Governmental Agencies
4. Committee for Natural Resources
5. Committee for Transnational Corporations
6. Committee on Human Settlement.

There are also certain ad-hoc bodies like the Ad hoc Open-ended Inter-Governmental Group of Experts on Energy and Sustainable Development and Ad Hoc Open-ended Working Group on Informatics.

There are certain expert bodies composed of governmental experts such as the Committee of Experts on the Transport of Dangerous Goods and on the Globally Harmonized System of Classification and Labelling of Chemicals and United Nations Group of Experts on Geographical Names.

Besides, there are expert bodies composed of members serving in their personal capacity, like the Committee of Experts on Public Administration, the Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights, and others.

Other related bodies of the Council include the International Narcotics Control Board and the Board of Trustees of the International Research and Training Institute for the Advancement of Women.

## Evaluation

Though the Economic and Social Council was created to fulfill the aspirations of the peoples of the United Nations in many cases it has been seen that the Council has been severely impaired and limited to discussion and recommendation. As in the case of other organs, the Council is also not free from big power politics. Therefore, it has not been able to deliver the goods to the people across the world. Therefore, from time to time, there have been suggestions for reforms. In 1969, a laudable reform effort was made by Sir Robert